

Complete Walkthrough

2025–2026 Filing Season · Step-by-Step · Every Line Explained

The PAS-1 is the single most important tax form for NJ seniors.

One form covers ANCHOR, Stay NJ, and Senior Freeze simultaneously.

This guide walks through every section line by line —

with examples, common errors, and exactly what documents you need.

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Published May 2026

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This guide is for informational purposes only. It does not constitute legal or tax advice. Program rules, deadlines, and benefit amounts change annually. Always verify current information at nj.gov or by calling 1-888-238-1233 before filing.

Before You Begin: What the PAS-1 Does

The PAS-1 (Property Tax Relief Application for Seniors) is a combined application that files for three separate programs in one submission:



■ **Deadline: November 2, 2026**

This is a hard deadline. No extensions. No exceptions. If you miss it, you must wait until next year's filing season to apply.

1 Who Must Use the PAS-1 (Not the ANC-1)

This is the most common mistake NJ seniors make — filing the ANC-1 (standard ANCHOR form) instead of the PAS-1. Filing the ANC-1 means you will **only receive ANCHOR** — you will not be considered for Stay NJ or Senior Freeze. You must use the PAS-1 if any of these apply to you:

- You are **age 65 or older** as of December 31 of the benefit year
- You receive **Social Security Disability Insurance (SSDI)**
- You receive **Railroad Retirement Board disability** benefits
- Your **spouse** meets any of the above, even if you do not

2 Documents to Gather Before You Start

Gather everything below before opening the form. Having documents ready prevents errors and saves time.

Required — All Applicants

- NJ driver's license or state-issued photo ID
- Social Security number (and spouse's if filing jointly)
- Current property tax bill (shows block, lot, municipality)
- Bank account number and routing number for direct deposit
- Most recent NJ-1040 tax return

Required — Income Documentation

- Form SSA-1099 (Social Security benefit statement)
- Form 1099-R (pension, IRA, annuity distributions)
- W-2s or 1099s for any employment income
- Schedule K-1 if you receive partnership or S-corp income
- Brokerage statements for dividend/interest/capital gain income

Required — Senior Freeze (PTR) Applicants

- Proof of NJ residency for at least 10 consecutive years
- Proof you have owned and lived in your current home for at least 3 years
- Prior year PTR-1 or PTR-2 (if you filed before)
- All property tax payment receipts or canceled checks for current year

For Disability Applicants

- SSDI award letter or Railroad Retirement Board disability determination
- This must show total permanent disability status

3 Line-by-Line Walkthrough

The PAS-1 has several sections. Below is a plain-English explanation of each part with exactly what to write and common mistakes to avoid.

PART A — Personal Information

Your Legal Name	Enter exactly as it appears on your Social Security card. Do not use nicknames.
Social Security Number	Your full 9-digit SSN. Required — the form cannot be processed without it.
Date of Birth	Month/Day/Year. Must confirm age 65+ for senior benefits.
Spouse Information	If married and filing jointly, enter spouse's name, SSN, and DOB. Both spouses must sign the completed form.
NJ Driver's License / ID	Enter the full number. Used to verify NJ residency.
Mailing Address	The address where your benefit check or direct deposit confirmation should be sent. Can differ from property address.

PART B — Property Information

Property Address	The address of the property you are claiming relief on. Must be your primary NJ residence.
Block and Lot	Found on your property tax bill or municipal tax records. Critical — without this the form cannot be matched to your tax record.
Municipality	The name of your specific town, not the county. For example: "Voorhees Township" not "Camden County."
County	Camden, Gloucester, or Burlington for South Jersey residents.
Ownership	Check "Own" or "Rent." For homeowners claiming ANCHOR, PTR, and Stay NJ, check "Own."

PART C — Income

Gross Income	Total income from ALL sources before any deductions. This is the number most applicants underestimate. Include wages, Social Security, pensions, IRA distributions, dividends, interest, rental income, and capital gains.
Social Security Income	Enter the gross amount from Box 5 of your SSA-1099. Do not use the taxable portion from your federal return — use the gross amount.

Pension/Annuity Income	Use the gross distribution from Box 1 of your 1099-R, not the taxable amount. This is the full amount before any exclusions.
Common Mistakes	Forgetting to include: (1) IRA distributions, (2) rental income, (3) capital gains from stock sales, (4) spouse's income if married filing jointly.

PART D — Property Tax Information

Annual Property Tax Paid	Enter the total property taxes paid during the benefit year. Use your tax payment receipts or your annual tax bill. Do not estimate.
Homestead / Previous Benefits	Disclose any prior year benefits received. Failing to report prior benefits can result in a recovery action against you.

PART E — Bank Information (Direct Deposit)

Routing Number	9-digit number at the bottom left of your checks. Do not use a deposit slip routing number — they are sometimes different.
Account Number	Your checking or savings account number. Double-check this — errors here delay payment by weeks.
Account Type	Check either "Checking" or "Savings."

SIGNATURE

Your Signature	Sign and date in ink. An unsigned form is invalid and will not be processed.
Spouse Signature	If married filing jointly, both spouses must sign.
Preparer Information	If someone helped you complete the form, their name and contact information must be listed here. John Scafide will complete this section if he assists you.

4 Common Errors That Get Applications Rejected

Wrong form	Senior used ANC-1 instead of PAS-1. Must refile with PAS-1.
Under-reported income	Forgetting IRA distributions, capital gains, or spouse income. NJ cross-references your federal return. Discrepancies trigger review.
Wrong block/lot	Entering county block/lot instead of municipal. Block and lot numbers are municipality-specific, not county-wide.
Using taxable SS, not gross SS	Box 5 of SSA-1099 is gross benefits. Box 5b on your 1040 is taxable benefits. Always use the gross amount.
Missing signature	Unsigned forms are returned unprocessed. Both spouses must sign if filing jointly.
Wrong routing number	Using a deposit slip routing number instead of the check routing number. These are sometimes different. Verify with your bank.
Incorrect property address	Must match the municipality's tax records exactly. "123 Main St" vs "123 Main Street" can cause matching failures.

Get Help for \$20

John Scafide will complete your PAS-1 line by line, check for errors, and submit before the deadline. Flat fee: \$20.

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